to communities of Charans, bards, and courtesans— they could collect from his cashier, a fixed amount annually.

Not all officers found that the life of a mansabdar suited them, however. One Husamuddin, son of Ghazi Khan Badakshi, while on campaign with Abdur Rahim and still a young man, decided that he wanted to become a fakir and devote his life to the service of Nizamuddin Auliya. Though Abdur Rahim tried to dissuade him, the young man 'smeared his body over with clay and mud and wandered about in the streets and bazaars'.[‡] Akbar allowed him to resign his post and Husamuddin asked his wife, who was the sister of Abu'l Fazl, to donate all her jewellery to dervishes.

While Akbar held court in Lahore, he sent Abdur Rahim to settle a promising region that had not displayed the sort of submission that Akbar required of his territories. The region of Sind was a rich land, famous for its cotton and silk cloth, ivory work, wooden furniture, leather, palanquin and chariot makers, salt-pits, and indigo. It had access to the sea, always an important consideration as the Portuguese were in possession of Goa. Sind had been controlled by relatives of the Mughals, the Tarkhans,[*] who had even sent a daughter, Sindhi Begum, for Akbar to marry. But the Padshah had refused the bride, as a clear indication of his disapproval at the way Sind was being governed. So, in 1590, Abdur Rahim was sent to Sind where he was able to overcome the stiff resistance of Mirza Jani Beg Tarkhan, who was then obliged to appear at court and accept his position as banda-i dargah (servant of the court). He was no longer to consider himself an independent ruler, Akbar explained to Jani Beg, but a mansabdar of 3,000 of the Mughal court, and was given the subah of Multan in lieu of Thatta. However, when reports reached Akbar that the entire Arghun clan of Jani Beg, some 1,000 men, women, and children were boarding boats and travelling in great distress to Jani Beg's new subah, the Padshah relented and reassigned Thatta to the Tarkhans. Akbar also accepted a daughter as bride for Abdur Rahim's son, Mirza Irij. Jani Beg, a talented poet who wrote verses under the pen name of 'Halimi', went on to become a favourite of Akbar's, who was impressed by 'his character, religious views, pleasing manners and practical wisdom', no doubt helped by the fact that Jani Beg became a 'murid' of Akbar's.[†]

But Akbar was altogether less pragmatic when it came to the happiness of his family. In 1592, when his daughter Shakr un-Nisa fell gravely ill, Akbar was unable to watch helplessly as death, his one, redoubtable foe,